

## JERIK CRUZ

### education

#### Massachusetts Institute of Technology

PhD in Political Science (Cambridge, MA; expected 2026)

*Dissertation:* World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South

★ Awardee for 2024 NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant

*Fields:* Political Economy, Political Methodology, Comparative Politics (*High pass, all general exams*)

*Affiliations:* Graduate Research Fellow, [MIT GOV/LAB](#)

#### Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies

Master in Development Studies (Geneva, CHE)

*Awards:* Prunier Foundation Scholar, Graduate Institute Scholar, Prix Christophe Pralong

#### Ateneo de Manila University

A.B in Economics (Honors program), Minor in Philosophy, *Cum Laude* (Manila, PHL)

### research interests

Comparative politics; political economy; economic geography; development; bureaucracy; technology.  
Computational and historical methods. *Area foci:* Southeast Asia, North America.

### selected peer-reviewed articles

with Emille de la Cruz. 2023. “[Platforming populism: the services transition, precarious urbanization, and digital platforms in the rise of illiberal populism in the Philippines](#).” *Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society*. Special Issue: *The Power of Platforms* 16(12): 269-288

with Manuel Montes. 2020. “[The political economy of foreign investment and industrial development: the Philippines, Malaysia and Thailand in comparative perspective](#).” *Journal of the Asia Pacific Economy* 20: 16-39

### work in progress

“World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South” (Job Market Paper)

“From precarity to populism: the politics of democratic erosion in the Philippines” (with [Enrico La Viña](#))

“The digital developmental state” (with [Andrew Stokols](#))

The US tariff data project: American trade politics from 1789-2023 (with [In Song Kim](#), [Geondo Kim](#))

OpenAudit: advancing governance research with LLM-processed audit reports (with [Philip Arnold Tuaño](#), [Enrico La Viña](#))

★ Winner, 2023 MIT Prize for Open Data

### selected fellowships

|                                                                                                                |            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <a href="#">Massachusetts Institute of Technology</a> Social and Ethical Responsibilities of Computing Scholar | 2025       |
| <a href="#">Tagpuan Center, Ateneo de Manila University</a> Fellow for Bridging Cultural Divides               | 2025       |
| <a href="#">Institute for Humane Studies</a> Junior Fellow                                                     | 2024, 2025 |
| <a href="#">Harvard Kennedy School Program on Science, Technology, and Society</a> Predoctoral Fellow          | 2023       |
| <a href="#">Mercatus Center, George Mason University</a> Adam Smith Fellow                                     | 2023       |
| <a href="#">Southeast Asia Research Group</a> Pre-Dissertation Fellowship                                      | 2022       |
| <a href="#">Ronald Coase Institute</a> Ronald Coase Institute Fellowship                                       | 2020       |
| <a href="#">Massachusetts Institute of Technology</a> Homer A. Burnell Presidential Fellowship                 | 2020       |

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                    |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| selected<br>grants<br>and awards | NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant Award (Total: \$15,400)                                                                                                                             | 2024                               |
|                                  | Institute for Humane Studies Fellowships and Research Grants (Total: \$14,000)                                                                                                                       | 2023, 2024                         |
|                                  | MIT GOV/LAB MIT GOV/LAB Seed Grant (Total: \$10,000)                                                                                                                                                 | 2022, 2024                         |
|                                  | MIT Center for International Studies Summer Study Research Grant (Total: \$7,600)                                                                                                                    | 2023, 2024                         |
|                                  | MIT School of Science and MIT Libraries MIT Open Data Prize                                                                                                                                          | 2023                               |
|                                  | Ateneo de Manila University Research Council Conglomerates and Inclusive Growth (\$65,000)                                                                                                           | 2018                               |
|                                  | International Development Research Centre Economics of Tobacco Control Initiative (\$200,000)                                                                                                        | 2018                               |
| selected<br>presentations        | Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop                                                                                                                                        | 2025                               |
|                                  | Midwest Political Science Association, IL                                                                                                                                                            | 2023, 2025                         |
|                                  | Institute for Humane Studies, Juniors Fellows Conference, NC                                                                                                                                         | 2024, 2025                         |
|                                  | Qualitative Bayesian Reasoning Network Workshop (Online)                                                                                                                                             | 2023, 2025                         |
|                                  | Harvard-MIT-Boston University Cambridge Chinese Politics Research Workshop, MA                                                                                                                       | 2024                               |
|                                  | Asia School of Business Research Seminar, Kuala Lumpur                                                                                                                                               | 2024                               |
|                                  | American Political Science Association                                                                                                                                                               | 2023                               |
| selected<br>teaching             | MIT-Brown Development Workshop (RI, MA)                                                                                                                                                              | 2022, 2023                         |
|                                  | <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>                                                                                                                                                         |                                    |
|                                  | Political Science Laboratory: Regression and Causal Inference, Instructor (UG)                                                                                                                       | Spring 2025                        |
|                                  | Quantitative Methods I: Regression Foundations, Teaching Assistant (G)                                                                                                                               | Fall 2023                          |
|                                  | <i>Ateneo de Manila University</i>                                                                                                                                                                   |                                    |
|                                  | International Political Economy, Instructor (UG/G)                                                                                                                                                   | Spring 2020                        |
|                                  | Theory and Practice of Development, Instructor (UG)                                                                                                                                                  | Fall 2017, 2018, 2019; Spring 2019 |
| leadership<br>and service        | Introduction to Economics, Instructor (UG)                                                                                                                                                           | Spring 2017                        |
|                                  | Co-Founder and Organizer, MIT Computational Social Science Graduate Student Workshop                                                                                                                 | 2025                               |
|                                  | Committee for the MIT Open Data Prize, MIT Open Data Prize                                                                                                                                           | 2024, 2025                         |
|                                  | Board Member and Communications Chair, 70 Amherst Graduate House Government                                                                                                                          | 2023-2025                          |
|                                  | Mentor, MIT Political Science Graduate Mentorship Program                                                                                                                                            | 2022-2023, 2024-2025               |
|                                  | Mentor, GradMap Philippines (STEM mentorship network for Filipinos)                                                                                                                                  | 2021-2023                          |
|                                  | Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Chair, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council                                                                                                               | 2021-2023                          |
| selected<br>policy<br>consulting | <i>Reviewer: Journal of Southeast Asian Economies, Competition &amp; Change, Philippine Studies: Historical &amp; Ethnographic Viewpoints, Journal of Contemporary Asia, Perspective on Politics</i> |                                    |
|                                  | Open Society Foundations                                                                                                                                                                             | New York, USA                      |
|                                  | Consultant, Asia-Pacific Program                                                                                                                                                                     | 2023                               |
|                                  | The Asia Foundation                                                                                                                                                                                  | Manila, PHL                        |
|                                  | Lead Technical Advisor, Coalitions for Change Program                                                                                                                                                | 2023                               |
|                                  | United Nations Development Program                                                                                                                                                                   | Manila, PHL                        |
|                                  | Political Scientist Consultant, Pintig Lab and COVID-19 FASSSTER project                                                                                                                             | 2020-2022                          |

selected  
policy  
publications

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2024. “The services transition, platform capitalism, and the path to illiberal populism: insights from the Philippines” in *Understanding the drivers of political polarization and social exclusion in Southeast Asia*. Country Technical Report. New York: Open Society Foundations

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2022. “From Dependency to Autonomy: Local Governance, Fiscal Capacity, and the Outlook for Philippine Local Governments in the post-COVID era,” in *Decentralization, Digitalization, and Development: Strengthening Local Governance for Recovery, Resilience, and the Sustainable Development Goals* Manila: United Nations Development Program (lead flagship report chapter)

A. Ang, J. Cruz, and N. Custodio. 2019. “*The impact of trade on employment in the Philippines: a country report*” Country Technical Report. Manila: International Labour Organization

selected  
professional  
experience

|                                                                               |             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Ateneo de Manila University                                                   | Manila, PHL |
| <i>Lecturer</i> , Department of Economics                                     | 2017-2020   |
| <i>Economist</i> (Business & Government Program), Ateneo School of Government | 2017-2019   |

selected  
additional  
training

|                                                                                         |                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Systems Science for Social Impact, WashU in St. Louis                                   | 2021 (Network Analysis), 2025 (ABM) |
| Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University                | 2024                                |
| Bayesian Reasoning for Qualitative Social Science, London School of Economics           | 2022                                |
| Asia Institute for Political Economy, University of Hong Kong and Georgetown University | 2009                                |

computing

R, STATA, Python,  $\LaTeX$ , HTML, Markdown, GitHub, Qualtrics, MS Office

languages

English (Native), Tagalog (Native), French (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate), Mandarin (Beginner)

references

**Ben Ross Schneider**

Ford International Professor  
Massachusetts Institute of Technology  
Department of Political Science  
[brs@mit.edu](mailto:brs@mit.edu)

**In Song Kim**

Associate Professor  
Massachusetts Institute of Technology  
Department of Political Science  
[insong@mit.edu](mailto:insong@mit.edu)

**Volha Charnysh**

Ford Career Development Associate Professor  
Massachusetts Institute of Technology  
Department of Political Science  
[charnysh@mit.edu](mailto:charnysh@mit.edu)

**Kenneth Oye**

Professor Emeritus  
Massachusetts Institute of Technology  
Department of Political Science  
[oye@mit.edu](mailto:oye@mit.edu)

**Tasha Fairfield**

Chair in Comparative Politics  
Department of Political and Social Sciences  
European University Institute  
[tasha.fairfield@eui.eu](mailto:tasha.fairfield@eui.eu)